

Rye Country Day School
Model United Nations Conference I

April 18th, 2026



Economics and Financial Affairs Council
Ethics of Artificial Intelligence in Business

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Letter from the Secretariat

Dear Delegates and Faculty Advisors,

We are honored and excited to invite you to the inaugural Rye Country Day School Model United Nations Conference (RCDSMUNC I), which will take place on Saturday, April 18th, 2026. RCDS is thrilled to have such an incredible group of students on campus, working together to find solutions to real world issues.

The Secretariat, along with our faculty advisor, Mr. Murray, have been working diligently over the past year to coordinate our first conference. Our goal for RCDSMUNC I is to inspire delegates to collaborate while developing their knowledge on impactful global problems.

Our three committees cover a variety of topics, including the ethics of AI in business, the Equal Pay Act, and the Cold War.

We encourage you all to reach out to your chairs with any questions or concerns, and we hope you have an amazing and engaging conference. Good luck!

Best,

Zara Khemlani, Kevin Neilinger, and Lillian Pereira

RCDSMUNC I Secretariat

Committee Description

Artificial Intelligence (AI) is one of, if not the most, relevant topics in 2026. It is contributing to scientific research, speeding up previously time consuming processes, and is changing the way humans interact with technology. However, with all of its benefits, AI also has its downsides. Not only is it transforming the job market and

negatively impacting the environment, but it also raises various privacy and ethical concerns with its usage - especially in business. In this committee, delegates will be discussing the potential ethical implications and ramifications of using artificial intelligence in business oriented fields.

Background Information

Although most people believe that AI began with the invention of ChatGPT, AI has been around for much longer. In fact, neural networks, the foundational algorithm for artificial intelligence, were first proposed in 1943 and were later formally developed in the 1980s with the invention of backpropagation for training deep neural networks. However, AI saw rapid development in the 2010s with the launch of Apple's Siri (2011), the development of image recognition algorithms such as AlexNet (2012), AlphaGo's victory in 2016, and, most relevant to this assembly, the invention of the Transformer Architecture in 2017.

The Transformer Architecture would serve as the foundational model that powers almost all of the Large Language Models (LLMs) we use today (e.g., Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini). All that said, however, when most of us think about the "start" of Artificial Intelligence, we think about the release of ChatGPT 3.5 in November of 2022. The gap between the research world and the rest of the world had collapsed. What was previously an interesting research project had now become a tool that would fundamentally change civilization's trajectory. Although many people at the time thought we had reached the peak of

AI and its capabilities, they could not have been more wrong.

Since the release of ChatGPT in 2022, there have been various developments in the field of AI including the rise of LLM agents and a growing shift towards AI for science.

Interestingly, both of these developments represent two visions for the future of AI that are now converging, so we must discuss both of them.

The field of AI agents formally began with the release of autonomously independent language models such as AutoGPT in 2023 and the development of frameworks, such as LangChain in 2024, which enables AI agents to browse the internet, autonomously use tools, and call data from databases. In the past year, however, there have been rapid developments in Agentic AI - especially in the fields of reasoning, multi-agent orchestration, and coding agents. Some of the companies leading these rapid developments include OpenAI (Codex), Anthropic (Claude Code), LangChain, and OpenClaw (recently acquired by OpenAI). The developments in the field

of AI agents tend to have the largest impact in business because AI agents, specifically language model agents, are able to take on many tasks that companies spend anywhere from millions to billions of dollars on paying employees to complete these tasks.

Therefore, these companies - especially those who create these language model agents (e.g., OpenAI, Claude, Gemini) - are largely focused on scaling these language models to meet even greater capacities. Similarly, companies who are focused on creating Agentic frameworks (e.g., OpenClaw and LangChain) are focused on improving latency and the speed of their frameworks to also meet demand. As a result, the companies evolved in the field of AI agents are largely focused on scaling their models and frameworks to meet demand - rather than conducting novel, scientific research.

On the other hand, companies such as Google Deepmind, World Labs, the Lean Focused Research Organization, and the Arc Institute and researchers such as Yann LeCunn,

George Karniadakis, and Fei-Fei Li are leading machine learning research that goes beyond scaling. Before we continue further, it is important to note that certain companies such as Google DeepMind, Axiom Math, and Simile, either use AI agents to advance scientific machine learning and AI for science, or pursue AI for mathematics and reasoning, through their agent research. In recent years, some of the most important developments in the field of SciML or more broadly, AI for science, include the emergence of World Models (e.g., V-JEPA), AlphaFold 2 in 2020, Evo2 in 2025, the Lean4 in 2021, and the introduction of Physics-Informed Neural Networks (PINNs) in 2017, and Neural Operators in 2019-2020, respectively. These developments in the field of machine learning are unique from the developments of AI agents since they present frameworks that are transforming the field of machine learning research or are useful for solving scientific or mathematical problems that previously would have taken a very long time to solve - both computationally and literally

- or were previously unsolvable. For example, Neural Operators are able to approximate solutions to the Navier Stokes Equations that describe the motion of viscous, fluid substances, over 1000x faster than standard numerical methods. AlphaFold2 is able to predict 3D protein structures of a protein in less than a few hours on a single GPU; previously, predicting the exact 3D structure of a protein would take scientists months if not years to do. World Models are able to model the physical world, accurately modeling physics dynamics and giving machine learning models an understanding of the “world” dynamics rather than just the data they learn from. Lastly, models such as AxiomProver, released in December of 2025 by Axiom Math, achieved a perfect score on the Putnam exam (120/120) - outranking all contestants in the most difficult undergraduate mathematics competition on the planet.

Ultimately, the reality is simple: AI research is moving at an unprecedented rapid rate. So who exactly is regulating its advancement? The

answer, unfortunately, is very few organizations and people. The unique problem posed by AI is that it is such a novel technology that has become so deeply involved in our lives recently that only a few people have either, A, taken the time to learn more about it, or, B, are actively researching it. As a result, only a few, technically experienced researchers, or well informed individuals are capable of actively making informed actions on AI. Granted, a few people means a few million, if not hundreds of thousands, of individuals who are already educated on the topic so it is not to say that no one is actively attempting to regulate AI. One of these organizations, the International Association for Safe & Ethical AI, an organization led by Stuart Russel, a Distinguished Professor of Computer Science at UC Berkeley and author of *Artificial Intelligence a Modern Approach*, focuses on ensuring that “AI systems are guaranteed to operate safely and ethically, benefitting all of humanity.” Most AI Safety organizations, however, largely focus on publishing Human-Centered AI research,

such as Stanford's Human-Centered AI Institute. Additionally, organizations such as the European Union and United Nations are attempting to regulate AI, often using broad risk classifications. The challenge is that accurately assessing the nuanced risks of advanced ‘black box’ AI models requires specialized expertise, which only a small number of individuals in these organizations currently possess. Therefore, the fundamental problems to regulating artificial intelligence are that individuals do not properly understand this complex technology and that it is a rapidly evolving technology that seems to have only had a positive impact on technology.

That said, there are organizations that are attempting to raise AI literacy so that any individual can understand exactly what is going on in the AI research world. For example, the AI Youth Global Organization is creating educational resources on advanced topics in artificial intelligence, and is working with the Yee Collins Research Group to create a scientific communications

YouTube Channel to explain their research. The goal of these organizations is not only to educate the people who consume their resources, but to have their members become involved in the research world as well - focusing on creating open-source Human-Centered AI research projects that benefit the whole of humanity. Additionally, certain groups such as the Center for AI Safety and Harvard's AI Safety Student Team are raising awareness about the exact risks of Artificial Intelligence and how to mitigate those risks with deep technical insight. However, these organizations not

only focus on the future risks of AI, but also on the risks of AI in its current state with a heavy focus on AI agents and Large Language Models since they pose environmental risks (e.g., the resource-intensive training of language models) and social risks (e.g., drastically shrinking the job market). Although these organizations are led by technically skilled individuals, they aim to help raise deep, not surface-level, awareness about AI.

Current Situation

Currently, many major businesses have begun to increase their usage of AI in their companies, especially due to fear that they will be at a disadvantage without its use. In particular, high performers are using AI to drive growth, innovation, and cost. However, the use of AI this advanced is still new, and has little legislation surrounding it; most organizations are still in the experimenting or piloting phase. In the US

specifically, the large majority of laws surrounding AI are at a state level, and mostly deal with issues such as Montana's "Right to Compute" law, which sets requirements for critical infrastructure that is controlled by AI systems. This means that there is little world-wide legislation regarding AI, and that this committee will be one of the first of its kind to attempt to enact world-wide regulations on AI in business.

At this moment, the main issues surrounding AI can be summarized by its sustainable impact, i.e. its effects on the economy, society, and the environment. Economically, companies have declared that AI has helped them to cut costs company-wide due to its efficiency. However, AI's use has caused thousands of white-collar jobs in the US to have the potential to disappear, affecting thousands of people and their families. In terms of its social effect, there have been many debates surrounding the ethics of AI in business. These include issues of digital amplification, algorithmic bias, cybersecurity, privacy, and inclusiveness.

The debate about the morality of excessive AI use has become a hot seat recently, and may inform countries' stances on AI. Finally, ecologically, AI poses a major environmental threat. Data centers that are crucial to AI's functionality require a massive amount of water to be used and leaves the water unable to be reused. AI also leaves behind a massive carbon footprint. Overall, there is a huge gap in terms of global laws surrounding AI, and it is the job of this committee to fill that gap in whichever way they see fit.

Possible Solutions

Nations may consider a wide range of factors when regarding possible solutions to this issue. They will have to question what legislative actions can and should be taken against AI in business. It is also important for delegates to consider the sustainable (i.e. social, economic, and environmental) consequences AI may have on the business world. Delegates may choose to advocate for the expansion of AI in the business

world, crafting legislation based around protecting its right to be used. This especially may come due to the economic benefits AI in business can provide countries. Delegates can also fight for stricter regulations surrounding AI in business, if their concerns lie in the ways AI may negatively present itself in global business. Overall, countries must consider not only what route would be best for their

specific country, but what actions would most greatly benefit the world at large.

Delegate Positions

Please research as much as you can about your committee member, including but not limited to his personal political goals, public image, and who he is most likely to target. This should serve as a mere overview.

- 1. United States** As a leader in global AI innovation and home of the "Magnificent Seven," the United States embraces AI with strong focus on its implementation in national security, defense, and financial sectors. The nation has generally opposed regulation on AI to avoid slowing innovation and competitiveness.
- 2. United Kingdom** The United Kingdom supports AI, encouraging its growth through private enterprise and start-up's; however, the kingdom encourages more regulation and has advocated for more flexible global standards and norms as opposed to rigid legislation.
- 3. Canada** Canada is a leader in both AI research and AI ethics and governance. The country tends to prioritize transparency and accountability with the goal of establishing global norms in financial markets and government.
- 4. France** While France has emerged as an early adopter of AI, its skepticism with regard to the technology has been revealed through its strong support of data protection laws, algorithmic accountability, and overall digital safety. The nation promotes strong oversight and regulation on AI via binding agreements in national, regional, and global spheres.
- 5. Germany** Germany has quickly adapted AI with strong competition in industry, robotics and manufacturing. Nevertheless, Germany still leans towards social protection with strong emphasis on the need for worker protections, fair taxation, and strict safeguards to protect personal privacy and the environment.

6. **Netherlands** The Netherlands generally aligns itself with many other EU nations balancing innovation with strict ethical AI frameworks and guidelines.
7. **Spain** Spain endorses EU-wide regulation emphasizing the need to protect consumers and public services along with their employees.
8. **Australia** Despite strong investment and innovation in AI, Australia has recently moved to develop clear regulatory guardrails following concerns about the magnification of misinformation and the abuses that might stem from AI. Australia seeks to implement guardrails without it being at the expense of AI innovation.
9. **Mexico** Mexico is a leader in its region for AI seeing it as an opportunity to develop and diversify its economy. While Mexico is concerned about rapid modernization and potential exclusion for the poor and elderly, it has strongly been in favor of AI's development and support in finance for developing economies.
10. **China** China is undoubtedly a leader in AI, seeing AI innovation boom as a result of direct state-driven and strategic investment. While the nation has placed strict state control and censorship within its borders, it has regularly promoted AI on a global scale, seeing the novel technology as an opportunity to ensure national security and garner global influence.
11. **Japan** As a long time leader in technology, Japan has taken a moderate, pro-innovation approach to AI. The nation supports soft regulatory guidelines and favors international cooperation and standards over heavy restrictions.
12. **Philippines** As an emerging economy, the Philippines sees AI as a strategic opportunity for growth economically, politically, and militarily. The Philippines seeks global collaboration for equitable access to AI funding, training and research.
13. **South Korea** The Republic of Korea punches well above its weight in terms of leadership in AI. The nation's massive technology conglomerates such as Samsung, Hyundai, LG, and SK, have enabled significant growth without the

expense of public trust and safety. The nation would approve of innovation alongside structured oversight.

- 14. Nigeria** While Nigeria has supported AI as a means for accelerating development, the nation currently faces many challenges including infrastructure, funding, and skilled labor shortages. Nigeria seeks global collaboration to increase education, inclusion, and infrastructure in AI and tech, hoping that it will bring economic growth and stability.
- 15. Kenya** Kenya is a regional leader in tech and AI with strong emphasis on applications in finance and agriculture. The nation's stance embraces innovation with emphasis on equitable access to this new technology.
- 16. Iran** Iran, concerned about Western dominance and AI's potential to undermine its own domestic control, remains a staunch skeptic when it comes to AI. Despite this skepticism and limited access to AI resources due to American sanctions, the Iranian government has gradually implemented AI into defense and propaganda.
- 17. Afghanistan** Afghanistan has minimal AI capacity as a result of high internal instability, and low quality infrastructure and education. Afghanistan seeks global cooperation to support its economy and public sectors (e.g., medicine and education).
- 18. Russia** Russia balances AI ambition with geopolitical caution. With a focus on military and surveillance AI, Russia generally avoids Western technology and favors sovereign and autonomous control of AI over global frameworks.
- 19. Singapore** Singapore is a leader in global AI governance with advanced regulatory frameworks that still promote competitiveness. Singapore believes in strong public-private cooperation and looks to scale global AI standards.
- 20. Saudi Arabia** As a means of diversifying its economy from natural resources like oil and gas, Saudi Arabia has invested heavily in AI. Saudi Arabia sees AI as a part of its Central Vision to 2030 and supports large, global minded investment and tech partnerships.

21. India India has rapidly adopted AI prioritizing growth over regulation so far.

Moreover, India pushes for inclusive AI development and affordable access.

22. South Africa South Africa has struggled with AI adoption in spite of its enthusiasm surrounding the tech. Nevertheless, the nation supports AI as a means of reducing poverty, inequality, and even corruption.

23. Brazil Brazil is a regional leader in AI with heavy emphasis on ethical and structured AI governance. Brazil sees AI as an opportunity to further enter their influence in the global economy and seeks global collaboration to promote frameworks that balance growth alongside protections (e.g., environmental and privacy).

24. Israel Israel is a top innovation hub, producing strong AI startups dedicated to defense and cybersecurity. Israel emphasizes global cooperation especially in economics innovation, venture capital, and security applications.

25. United Arab Emirates (UAE) The United Arab Emirates has one the most ambitious AI adoption strategies placing heavy emphasis on AI in public services and defense. The UAE seeks to become a global leader in AI, pushing for rapid adoption, global investment, and global leadership.

Questions to Consider

Here are some questions to help guide you in conference speeches and our collaborative investigation together.

1. Does AI have a place in global business?
2. Is it ethical to have AI replace the tasks of significant portions of the world's labor force? How will countries navigate this massive labor shift?
3. Who is responsible for the regulation of AI? Who holds AI companies accountable when these regulations are violated?

4. Should more research on the effect of AI in society be completed before the technology is implemented.
5. Should there be global regulations on AI? How does that regulation manifest itself?
6. How do governments protect their citizens' privacy from data-mining and LLM's that could potentially exploit their personal information?